Apex Systems: Response to RFP-2026-014: Cloud Contract and Invoice Management Platform for Meridian Manufacturing Ltd (fictional company)

1. Executive Summary and Understanding of the Requirement

Meridian Manufacturing needs one platform to manage supplier contracts, purchase-order matching and invoices for about 2,000 users across six plants. Apex Systems proposes a cloud-native, API-first platform built on a microservices architecture and deployed on Kubernetes in two availability zones. We have read the requirement carefully and see three priorities: reliable integration with SAP S/4HANA, strong auditability, and the ability to scale as new plants are added.

Our design has been load tested at 5,000 concurrent users and provides a 99.95% availability SLA. All integrations use documented REST APIs and an event-driven message bus, so Meridian is not locked into point-to-point interfaces.

2. Proposed Solution and Implementation Approach

Architecture: stateless microservices behind an API gateway, PostgreSQL clusters with automatic failover, and an event bus for asynchronous processing. Horizontal scaling is automatic and has been tested to three times the stated volume.

Integrations: standard connectors for SAP S/4HANA (IDoc and OData), Oracle ERP, and Microsoft Entra ID for single sign-on (SAML 2.0 and OIDC). A published API catalogue and webhooks allow Meridian's own teams to extend the platform. Integration testing is included for every connector.

Implementation approach: discovery, configuration, integration, user acceptance testing, and cutover. Data migration uses automated validation scripts with reconciliation reports.

3. Timeline, Team Structure and Milestones

Milestone	Target
Discovery and design sign-off	Month 2
Core platform configured	Month 4
SAP and SSO integration complete	Month 6
User acceptance testing	Month 8
Go-live	Month 10

A delivery team of 11: one programme manager, two solution architects, four engineers, two integration specialists, one QA lead and one security engineer. The programme manager will be named at contract signature.

4. Price Table and Assumptions

Item	Price
Platform licence (3 years)	USD 780,000
Implementation and integration	USD 520,000
Hosting and operations (3 years)	USD 180,000
Total 3-year cost	**USD 1,480,000**

Assumptions: Pricing assumes 2,000 named users, two ERP connectors and one data migration. Additional connectors are USD 45,000 each. Standard support is included; 24x7 support is an optional USD 120,000 per year.

5. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

Apex holds ISO 27001 and SOC 2 Type II certifications, renewed annually. Data is encrypted at rest (AES-256) and in transit (TLS 1.3). Role-based access control and mandatory MFA apply to all administrator accounts.

Independent penetration tests are carried out twice a year and the executive summary is shared with customers. A full immutable audit log records every user and system action and is retained for seven years. Our GDPR data processing agreement is included in the contract, with EU data residency.

Incident response: a documented plan with a 1-hour notification commitment for confirmed security incidents.

6. Support Model, Relevant Experience and References

Standard support is available Monday to Friday, 08:00 to 18:00 CET, with a 4-hour response for priority-one issues. 24x7 support is available as an optional extra. A named technical account manager is assigned to Meridian.

Apex has delivered five comparable contract and invoice platforms for manufacturers in the last six years. References: Halden Components (Procurement Director) and Northvale Foods (Head of Finance Systems); contact details are available during due diligence.

7. Commercial Terms and Validity

This response is valid for 90 days from the submission date. Prices are quoted in US dollars and exclude applicable taxes. Payment terms are 30 days from invoice, with implementation fees invoiced against agreed milestones.

The supplier confirms that it has read the RFP, accepts the evaluation process described in it, and will treat all Meridian Manufacturing information as confidential. Any exceptions to the draft contract will be listed during clarification.